

based adventure games. Games such as *Adventure* and *Zork* established this genre for consoles and PCs.

When affordable computers started catching up and surpassing the graphics of consoles in the late '80s,

games with motion graphics and other genres became more popular. The text adventure was later classified as interactive fiction, and a small, dedicated fan club has kept the genre going—with new releases being offered for free.



The Commodore 64 was one of the earliest gaming computers

In 1980, a game called *Mystery House* was published for the Apple II. This game has the distinction of having been called the first graphic adventure for home computers. The graphics, though, were simple static monochrome drawings, and the interface consisted of typed commands, but the game still proved very popular at the time.

In 1983, SuperSet Software created a text-based computer game called *Snipes*. This game, played over a network, was designed to test a particular network. And that led to an invention that brought about a big change in the network capabilities of a machine: today *Snipes* is officially credited as being the original inspiration for Novell Netware. The game is also the first network game ever written for a commercial personal computer, and is recognised alongside 1974's *Maze War* (a networked multiplayer maze game for several research machines) and *Spasim* (a 3D multiplayer space simulation for time shared mainframes) as the precursor to multi-player games such as *Doom* and *Quake*.

Games without graphics, however, wouldn't have retained a wide audience interest. Graphics and new sound features were